



contrast, the interior of the tomb is unadorned and simple, comprising a few bare chambers. Three of Darius's successors also commissioned tombs at the site, but these cannot be identified with certainty from the accompanying inscriptions.

Temple of Artemis at Ephesus

Location Ephesus, Turkey

The temple of Artemis, the Greek goddess of the hunt and the Moon, at Ephesus (see p.242), in modern-day Turkey, originated in the 7th century BCE but was destroyed by

floods and rebuilt from around 550 BCE by King Croesus of Lydia. His magnificent marble Ionic temple, measuring about 360 ft by 180 ft (110 m by 55 m), was surrounded by a double row of decorated columns—126 in all. In 356 BCE, it was deliberately burned down, but it was rebuilt in the same place to a similar design. Although the new building was slightly smaller, it was raised somewhat—giving it greater stature—and it also housed spectacular works of art. The reconstruction was impressive enough to be hailed as one of the seven wonders of the ancient world. The temple was destroyed by the Goths in 262 CE.

Mausoleum of Halicarnassus

Location Miletus, Turkey

Designed by the Greek architects Pythius and Satyros, the mausoleum of the Achaemenid ruler Mausolus was built on a hill above the city of Halicarnassus (now Bodrum), in c.353–350 BCE. A stairway, flanked by statues of lions, led to the podium supporting the marble tomb. The structure itself was virtually square, around 140 ft (43 m) high, surrounded by 36 Ionic columns, and adorned with artworks that included statues and sculptural reliefs. A 24-step pyramid at the top was crowned by a sculpture depicting a marble chariot. One of the seven wonders of the ancient world, the tomb was damaged by earthquakes between the 13th and 15th centuries CE.

Ruwanveliseya Dageba

Location Anuradhapura, Sri Lanka

The Ruwanveliseya is a gigantic Buddhist *dageba* (stupa, or domed reliquary shrine) built by King Dutugemunu in around 140 BCE, in the sacred city of Anuradhapura. The original brick structure would

have been encircled by two staggered platforms. An outer boundary wall, also made of brick, featured statues of elephants facing outward, reputedly with tusks of real ivory. Today, following considerable restoration and renovation, the structure is gleaming white and stands at around 338 ft (103 m) tall—almost twice its original height. It is one of the country's most venerated stupas and an important place of pilgrimage for Buddhists.

Great Chaitya

Location Karli, India

The *chaitya* (Buddhist prayer hall) at Karli, Maharashtra, is one of a series of rock-cut cave

shrines that were excavated between the 1st century BCE and the 1st century CE. Known as the Great Chaitya, it is distinctive not only as one of the best preserved and largest such halls of the period—it is 148 ft (45 m) long and 46 ft (14 m) high—but also for its impressive carvings and sculptures. The facade of the cave has a window and a huge column crowned by four lions. Inside, there is a vaulted ceiling, and the hall is flanked by two rows of columns with elaborate carvings, which lead to a circular ambulatory that houses a dome-shaped stupa.

▼ THE DRAMATIC CLIFF-CUT FACADE OF THE TOMB OF DARIUS I

